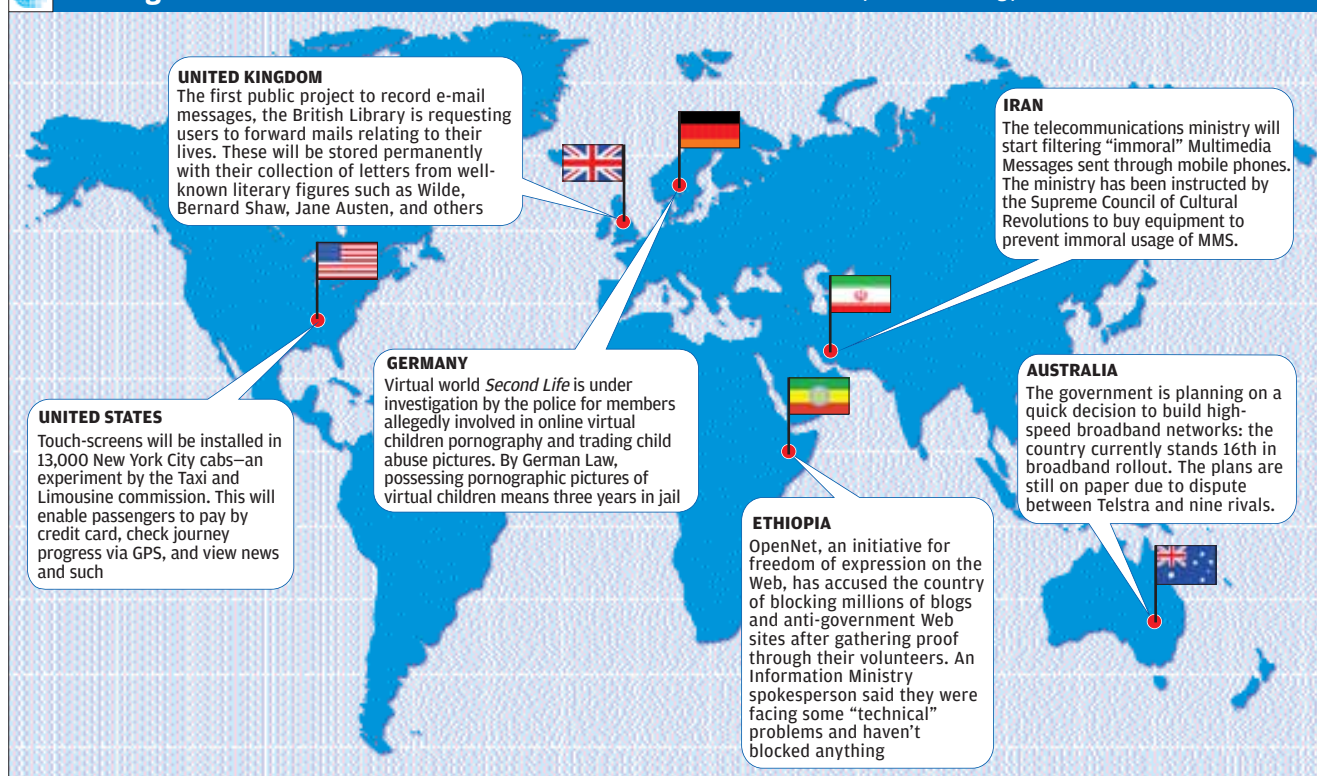


The Digital World

A Round-up Of Technology News From Across The Globe



support its honouring. FOSS patrons will have to adhere to the rules of the business as for the rest.”

Many multi-national companies and corporates from different sectors use Linux at their Data Centres, since the operating system can be customised in accordance with their requirements. Microsoft claims that the Linux kernel itself violates 42 patents, that Linux graphical user interfaces violate 65 other patents, OpenOffice programs violate 45 patents, and that a number of free or open source programs violate an additional 68 patents.

So first, Microsoft signs a deal with Novell for collaborative development of their products in November 2006. Microsoft then announces they’ll support the Open Document Format for businesses to provide them with better interoperability with the systems they choose to deploy. And then, they demanded royalties for infringement of 235 patents from free and open source software users.

Then, in a surprise move, Microsoft e-mailed an

official statement to ZDNetUK that they would not litigate. “If we wanted to go down that road we could have done that three years ago,” said a Microsoft spokesperson. “Rather than litigate, Microsoft has spent the last three years building an intellectual property bridge that works for all parties—including open source—and the customer response has been tremendously positive. Our focus is on continuing to build bridges.”

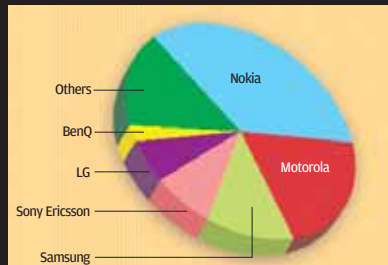
According to John McCreesh, OpenOffice.org marketing project lead, while Microsoft may not have plans to sue, it could be using the threat of litigation to encourage corporatesto move to those open source vendors with whom they had signed licensing agreements (such as Novell, as we’ve mentioned). “Microsoft has spent time and money accumulating patents. Maybe it has started using that armoury to move corporate customers to open-source software that Microsoft approves of,” McCreesh told ZDNet UK.



Stat Attack

It's all in the numbers

Mobile Phones Share, Q4 2006, Worldwide



LCD monitors use, on average, 50 to 70% less energy in On mode than CRTs do

An estimated **30,000** computers become **obsolete** every year from the IT industry in **Bangalore alone**. The reason—an extremely high obsolescence rate of **30%** per year

Top 10 countries with the highest number of Internet users

